

Contact

www.linkedin.com/in/tannerward3
(LinkedIn)

Top Skills

Technical Standards
Project Engineering
Android Studio

Certifications

Manage Access to AWS Resources
PLC Fundamentals
VMware VSP-HCI Accrediation
Certification
Crowdstrike Sales Certified

Tanner Ward

Software Engineer | Java • C++ • Python • Kubernetes • AWS |
Secret Clearance
United States

Summary

Software engineer with hands-on experience building safety-critical control systems. At Disney, I developed real-time software for ride control systems using PLCs, VFDs - including hardware integration on Tiana's Bayou Adventure. Currently building distributed simulation infrastructure for defense programs at Leidos. Interested in autonomous systems, robotics, and mission-critical software.

Experience

Leidos

Software Engineer

October 2024 - Present (1 year 9 months)

- Architected hardware-in-the-loop (HWIL) simulation software in Java/C++ for cyber range environments, enabling real-time emulation of distributed networked systems with strict timing constraints; directly analogous to functional model development for silicon architecture evaluation.
- Applied OOP design principles to build modular, extensible simulation components; designed RESTful APIs for resource allocation and built GitLab CI/CD pipelines with automated testing and compliance validation.
- Produced detailed software specifications, design documents, and test plans to DoD standards, supporting system integration reviews across a large-scale distributed codebase.

The Walt Disney Company

1 year 1 month

Controls System Engineering Intern

January 2024 - June 2024 (6 months)

Orlando, Florida, United States

- Developed safety-critical control system software for theme park attractions, ensuring strict reliability and fault tolerance under real-time operating constraints

- Programmed and tested PLC logic using Allen Bradley controllers and RSLogix 5000 for ride sequencing, safety interlocks, and E-stop handling
- Integrated VFD motor controls and configured communication protocols between PLCs and field devices
- Performed hands-on hardware integration and commissioning work on Tiana's Bayou Adventure, including wiring, I/O verification, and system checkout

Software Engineer Intern

June 2023 - December 2023 (7 months)

Orlando, Florida, United States

Blue Guardian

Software Engineer

May 2023 - December 2023 (8 months)

Tempe, Arizona, United States

Catalyze AI

Software Engineer

January 2023 - June 2023 (6 months)

Edupoint Educational Systems, LLC

Software Engineer Intern

January 2022 - July 2022 (7 months)

Mesa, Arizona, United States

Matrix Medical Network

Software Engineer Intern

April 2020 - December 2021 (1 year 9 months)

Scottsdale, Arizona, United States

Education

Arizona State University

Bachelor of Science - BS, Computer Science Engineering · (August 2021 - May 2024)